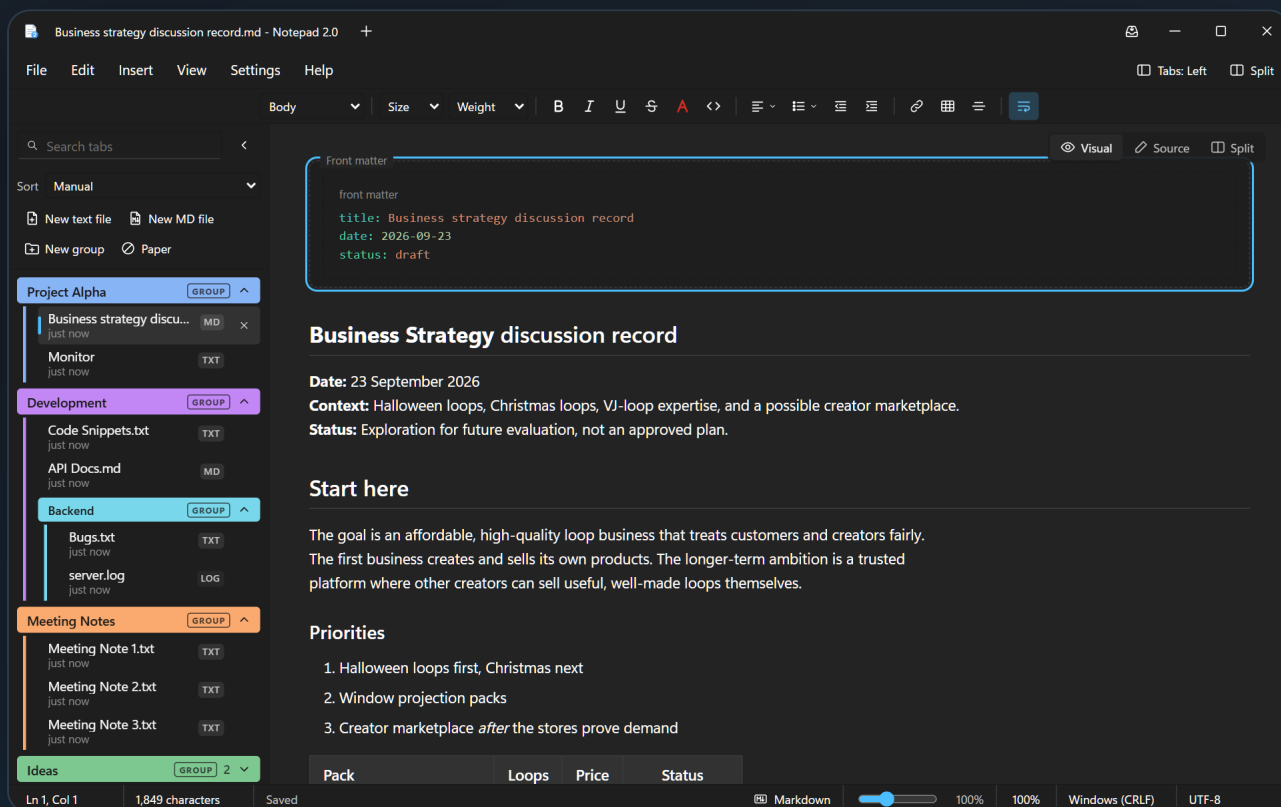


# Notepad 2.0

The Windows 11 Notepad you know, with file groups, a Markdown editor you type straight into, viewers for spreadsheets, data, PDFs and Word, several windows and a Quick Note one keypress away.



# Install, then your first five minutes

Setup takes a few seconds, installs for your user only (no admin password), and doesn't need a restart.

## Install

- Run **Notepad 2.0\_0.1.0\_x64-setup.exe** (or the **.msi**).
- Open **Notepad 2.0** from the Start menu. The first time, it offers a short tour.
- To open your **.txt** and **.md** files with it, or to replace **notepad.exe**, see *Windows integration* on page 7.

## Seven things to try

1

### New text file: **Ctrl + N**

Start typing. It autosaves until you choose where to keep it.

2

### New Markdown file:

**Ctrl + Alt + N**

It opens in the Visual editor. Use the toolbar for headings, colours, lists and tables.

3

### Make a file group

Right-click a tab, then *New file group...*  
Drag more files onto it.

4

### Change the layout

Click *Tabs* (top right): tabs on top, a sidebar, a rail, or the compact rail.

5

### Split the window

Click *Split* or press **Ctrl + \**: two documents side by side.

6

### Tear off a window

Drag a tab outside the window. It opens in a new window.

7

### Quick Note: **Win + Alt + N**

From anywhere. Type, click away, it's saved.

?

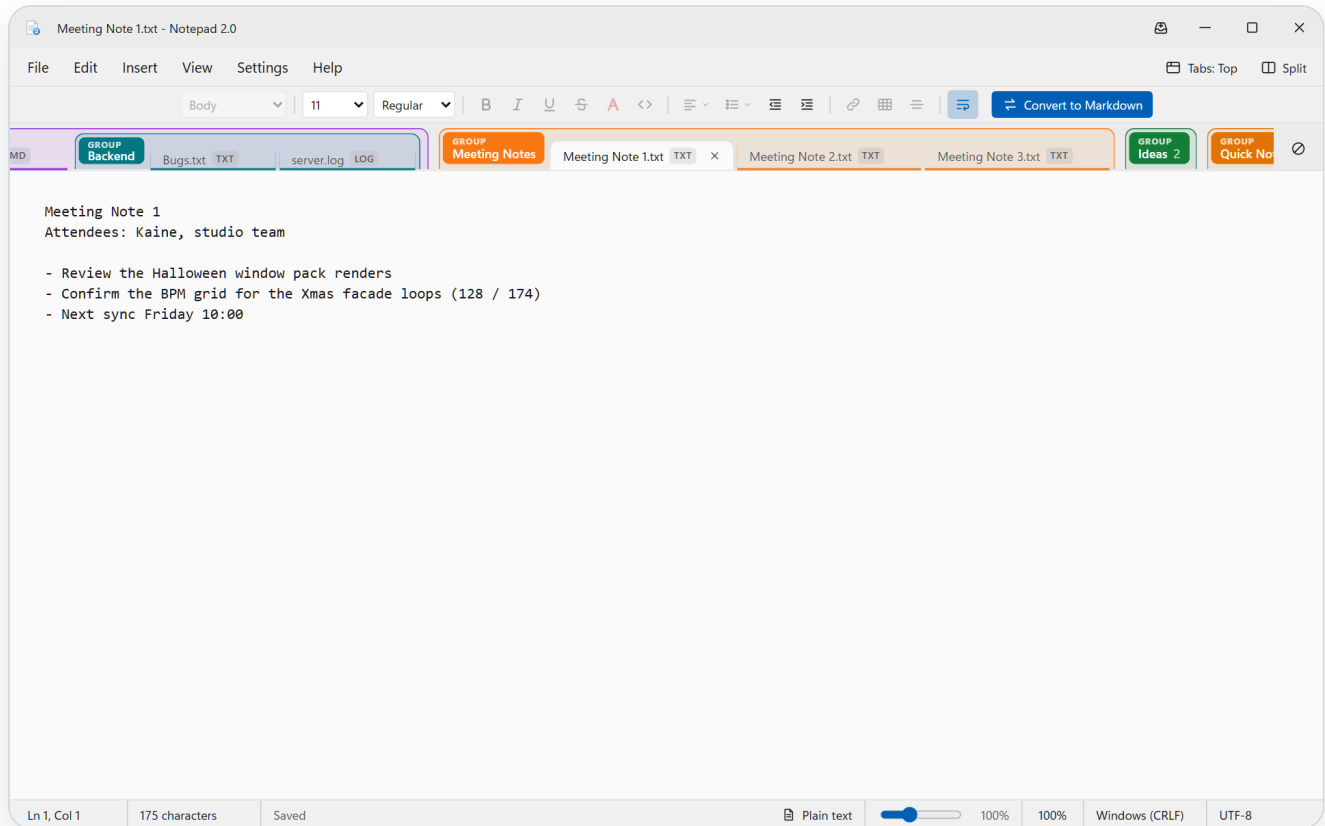
### Take the tour

*Help* → *Startup guide* spotlights each part of the window in 13 steps.

**Nothing is ever lost.** Untitled notes and Quick Notes save as you type. Opened files save with **Ctrl + S** like Notepad, but unsaved edits survive a crash or reboot and come back with a banner.

# It's still Notepad

Same menus, same shortcuts, same instant start. Plain text stays plain, and a file you haven't changed is never altered by a single byte.



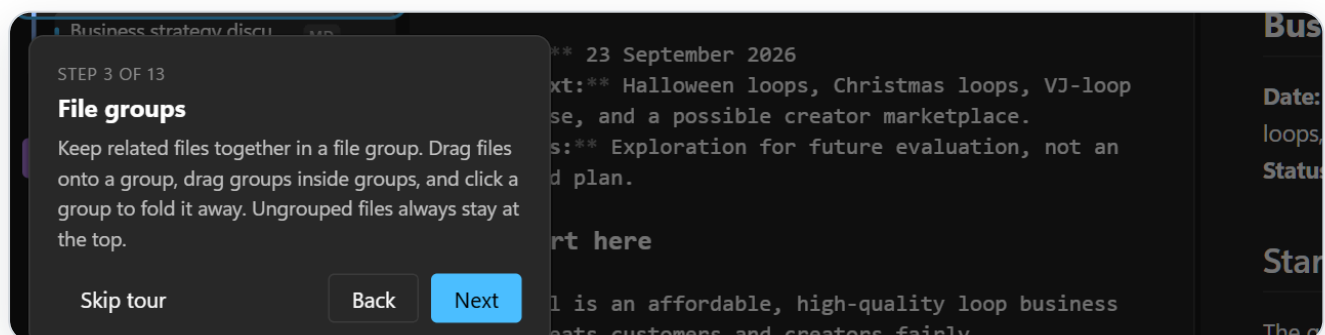
Light theme, tabs on top, a plain .txt file. On a text file only the tools plain text can hold are active, and a **Convert to Markdown** button appears.

## Everything Notepad does

- Find, Replace, Go to line, Print
- Date and time with **F5**
- UTF-8, UTF-16 and ANSI; CRLF or LF, shown in the status bar
- Font picker, word wrap, text zoom

## Look and feel

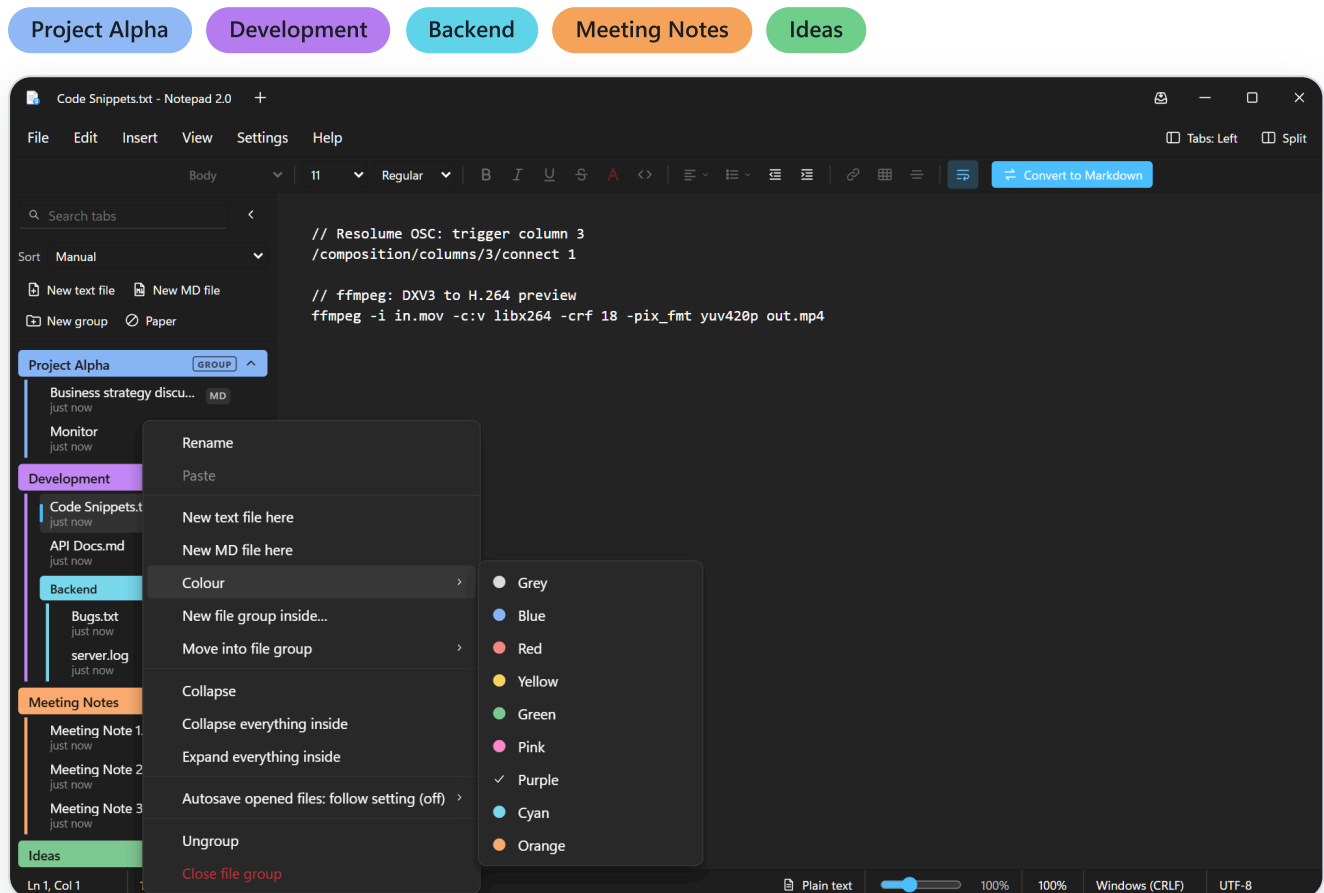
- **Light, Dark or System** theme
- **Interface size** 75–150% from the status-bar slider. Hold **Shift** and press **+** / **-** outside the text to nudge it.
- Text zoom (**Ctrl** **+** / **-**) is separate



New here? *Help* → *Startup guide* is a 13-step spotlight tour of the window, offered the first time you start.

# File groups, tabs and the sidebar

Keep related files together in coloured groups. Groups can sit inside groups, and ungrouped files always stay at the top.



Right-click a group to rename it, add files, change its colour, nest a group inside, collapse everything, or set autosave for the whole group.

## Layouts

- **Tabs on top**, joined to the page
- **Sidebar** on the left: drag its edge to resize
- **Rail**: a slim list of groups
- **Compact**: group names written vertically

## Sort

Manual, Date modified, Date created, Name A–Z or File type. Sorting is a view: your own order is kept.

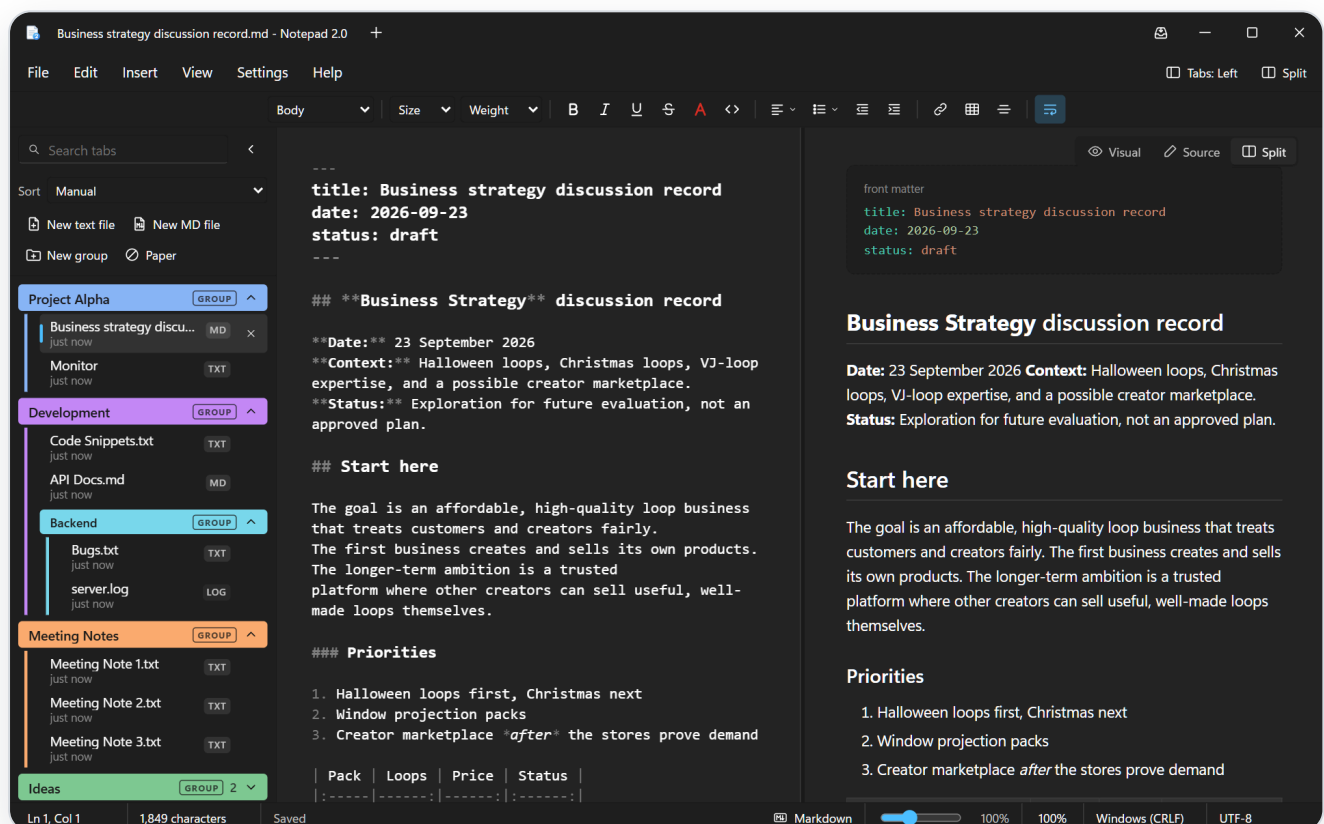
## File actions

- **Rename in place**: double-click or **F2**. Saved files are renamed on disk, never over an existing file.
- **Duplicate, Copy, Paste** into another group. Copies are named *Name (2).ext*.
- **Open in File Explorer**
- Right-click → **Colour** tints a single tab

# Markdown you can type into

Three views of the same file. Switch with the control in the document's top-right corner, or press **Ctrl + Shift + V**.

| VIEW          | WHAT IT'S FOR                                                                                                                            |
|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Visual</b> | A true WYSIWYG editor. Type straight into the formatted document, like a word processor.                                                 |
| <b>Source</b> | The raw Markdown, with syntax highlighting.                                                                                              |
| <b>Split</b>  | Source on the left, a live preview on the right: tables, task lists, footnotes, front matter, maths, Mermaid diagrams, highlighted code. |

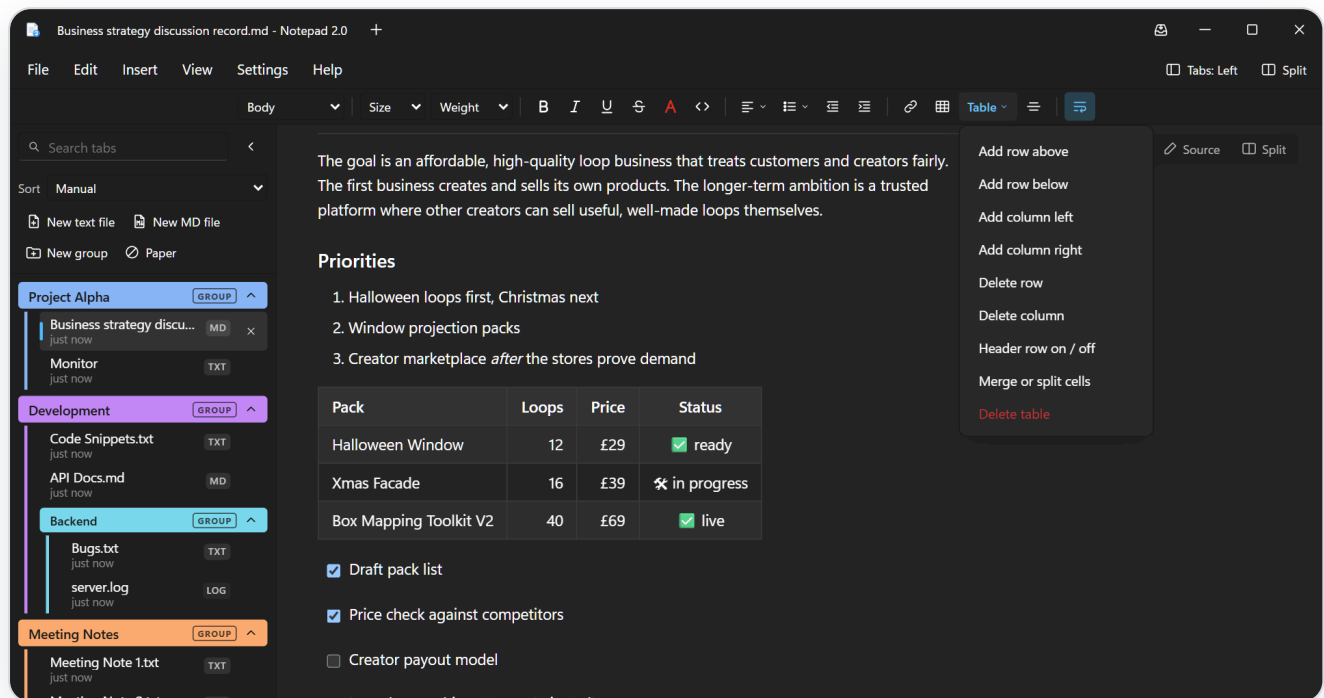


Split view. Formatting Markdown can't express (underline, colour, alignment) is saved as the small HTML tags GitHub understands, so files look right there too.

**Locked blocks.** Front matter, maths, Mermaid and other raw HTML show as locked blocks in Visual so nothing is mangled. Double-click one to edit it in Source.

# Tables, inserts and paper

Click inside a table and a **Table** menu appears on the toolbar.



Add or delete rows and columns, toggle the header row, merge or split cells. Drag borders to resize. Cells hold formatted text and lists.

## Insert menu

Page break, line break, image, table (with a size picker), link (**Ctrl** + **K**), horizontal line, date and time.

## Paper

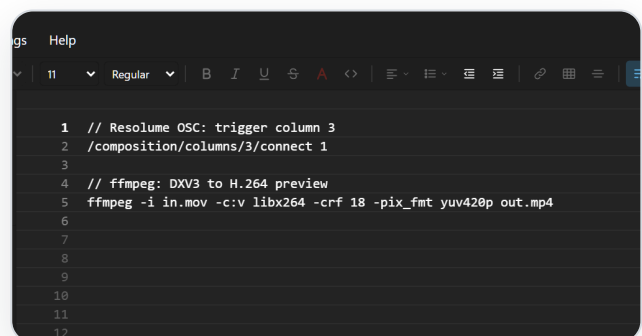
**None** A clean page

**Code** Line numbers down the whole page

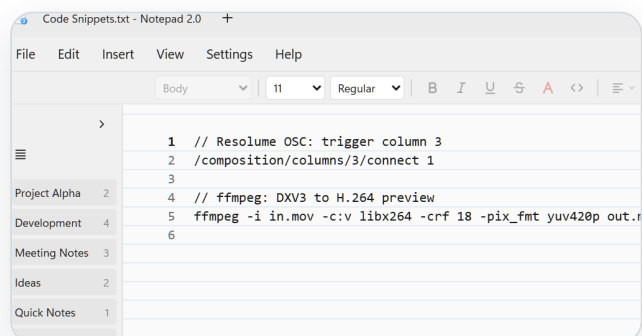
**Lines** Ruled writing paper

**Grid** Graph paper

For every tab or per tab. **Page margin** (0–200 px) works in every view.



Code paper

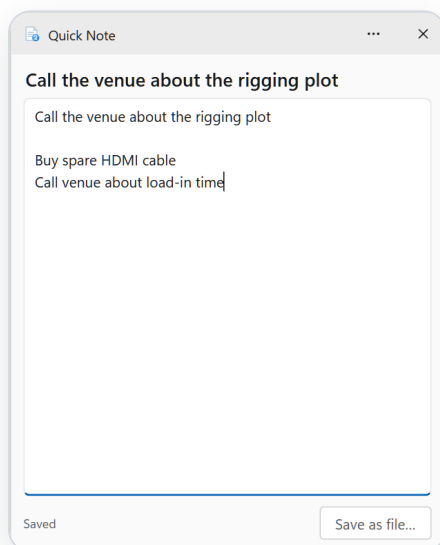


Lines paper, with the slim rail

# Windows, Quick Note and dictation

## Several windows

- **Drag a file, group or sub-group outside the window:** it opens in a new window at the pointer.
- **Drag between windows** to move items, dropped exactly where you let go.
- **Close a window** and its files move into the window you used last. Nothing is lost.
- **Restart** and every window comes back where it was, the last one you used in front.
- Opening a file that's already open elsewhere brings that window forward.



## Quick Note

Press **Win + Alt + N** anywhere, or click the tray icon. A small always-on-top note pops up above the tray and saves as you type. Your Quick Notes collect in a **Quick Notes** group in the main window.

## Dictate

Click the **microphone** button in the Quick Note to dictate with Windows voice typing (the same as **Win + H**). Speak, and your words appear in the note.

## Windows integration

In *Settings* → *Windows integration*:

- Default app for .txt and .md
- **Replace notepad.exe** (one admin prompt, reversible)
- *Edit with Notepad 2.0* in File Explorer's right-click menu
- Start with Windows, quietly in the tray

Uninstalling removes all of these.

## Split view

Click **Split** (top right) or press **Ctrl + \**. Click a side, then a tab, to load it there. The same document can be on both sides; typing shows on both.

# Spreadsheets, data, pages, PDFs and more

Open a file and Notepad 2.0 picks the right viewer. Text files keep a **View / Source / Split** switch, so you can read them formatted and still edit the raw text.

| FILES                    | SHOWN AS                                                                                         |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>CSV, TSV</b>          | A grid with a sticky header; click a column to sort. Edit in Source.                             |
| <b>XLSX, XLS, ODS</b>    | A grid per sheet with sheet tabs; values as Excel shows them. <i>File → Save sheet as CSV...</i> |
| <b>JSON, YAML, XML</b>   | A collapsible tree. A file with a mistake opens beside its source with the error line.           |
| <b>TOML, INI, logs</b>   | Highlighted text; ERROR lines red, WARN amber.                                                   |
| <b>HTML</b>              | The page with its own styling. Scripts never run.                                                |
| <b>Images, PDF, Word</b> | Zoomable images; Edge's PDF viewer; Word as formatted text with <i>Open in Word</i> .            |

|   | Role         | Performer     | Scenes  | Fee   | Status    |
|---|--------------|---------------|---------|-------|-----------|
| 1 | Stagehand    | Jo Reyes      | All     | £480  | Confirmed |
| 2 | Pumpkin King | Sam O'Neil    | 5       | £700  | Pending   |
| 3 | Ghost Host   | Ravi Patel    | 2, 3    | £900  | Confirmed |
| 4 | Narrator     | Ann Hale      | 1, 4, 9 | £1250 | Confirmed |
| 5 | Choir (x4)   | Hollow Voices | 6-8     | £2400 | Confirmed |

A CSV as a sortable grid

```

{
  "project": "Halloween Window Pack",
  "fps": 50,
  "resolution": { "width": 3840, "height": 1152 },
  "codecs": ["DXV3", "H.264"],
  "loops": [
    { "name": "Haunted Porch", "seconds": 16, "done": true },
    { "name": "Pumpkin Parade", "seconds": 32, "done": false }
  ],
  "upload": null
}

```

JSON: source and tree side by side

**Links go where they point.** In your notes, a link to a file opens it in a tab and a link to a **folder** opens File Explorer there, e.g. [Art](../Art%20Refs/). In the Visual editor, **Ctrl** +click to follow a link. *Insert → Link* has **File...** and **Folder...** buttons.

# Keyboard shortcuts

Every Notepad shortcut works as before. These are the ones worth learning.

## FILES AND TABS

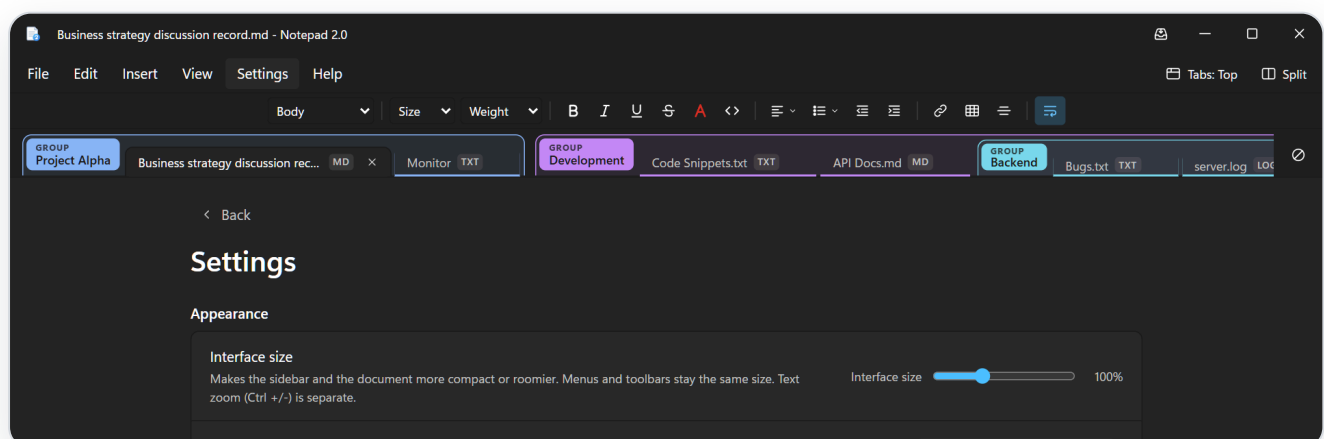
|                  |                           |
|------------------|---------------------------|
| Ctrl + N         | New text file             |
| Ctrl + Alt + N   | New Markdown file         |
| Ctrl + O         | Open                      |
| Ctrl + S         | Save                      |
| Ctrl + Shift + S | Save as                   |
| Ctrl + Alt + S   | Save all                  |
| Ctrl + W         | Close tab                 |
| Ctrl + Shift + W | Close window to the tray  |
| Ctrl + Shift + G | New file group            |
| F2               | Rename the current file   |
| Ctrl + P         | Print                     |
| Win + Alt + N    | Quick Note, from anywhere |

## EDITING AND VIEW

|                  |                                   |
|------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Ctrl + F         | Find                              |
| Ctrl + H         | Replace                           |
| Ctrl + G         | Go to line                        |
| F3 / Shift + F3  | Find next / previous              |
| F5               | Insert date and time              |
| Ctrl + K         | Insert link                       |
| Ctrl + click     | Follow a link (Visual)            |
| Ctrl + Shift + V | Visual → Source → Split           |
| Ctrl + \         | Split view on / off               |
| Ctrl + ] / [     | Indent / outdent a list item      |
| Ctrl + + / - / 0 | Text zoom in / out / reset        |
| Shift + + / -    | Interface size (outside the text) |
| Win + H          | Dictate                           |

## Where your notes are kept

- Files you open or save live **wherever you put them**, as ordinary .txt and .md files.
- Untitled notes, Quick Notes, groups, window layout and settings live in **%APPDATA%\Notepad2\**. Paste that into the File Explorer address bar to open it.



Settings: interface size, theme, font, tabs and groups, saving, Quick Note and Windows integration.  
Notepad 2.0 Quickstart